D H A R

Volume III — Ecosystem, Trust & Adoption

FUELING DHAR

“A forge that runs on donated coal for too long eventually goes cold.”

Document	Fueling Dhar — Business Model, Sustainability & Funding
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Part of	The Canon of Dhar, Volume III
Depends on	The Hallmark of Dhar (licensing), Casting Dhar (government contacts)
Audience	Funders, co-founders, leadership

1. Mandate

State plainly how the work in this Canon actually gets paid for, rather than leaving sustainability as an implied assumption. A single unfunded maintainer building a compiler, a package manager, and a standard library is not a funding gap this Canon can wish away with an MIT license and good intentions — it is the single most common reason ambitious open-source infrastructure projects stall after their first burst of momentum, and this document names real, existing funding mechanisms rather than generic ones.

2. Licensing as a Business Decision, Not Only a Legal One

Both existing repositories already carry an MIT license. The Hallmark of Dhar owns the legal reasoning; the business reasoning is simpler: a permissive license is the lowest -friction choice for the adopters Spec0 §5 names. Government and defence procurement in particular routinely screens out copyleft licenses (GPL-family) by policy, since they can impose obligations on adjacent, separately developed code that a procuring institution cannot always accept. MIT removes that objection before it's raised, at the direct cost of not requiring downstream contributions back — a trade this Canon makes deliberately, and revisits in §3 rather than pretending it has no cost.

3. Funding Pathways

3.1 Sovereign Tech Fund (and its emerging peers)

Germany's Sovereign Tech Fund, run by the Sovereign Tech Agency and financed by the Federal Ministry for Economic Affairs and Climate Action, has invested over €23 million in roughly 60 open-source infrastructure projects in its first two years, explicitly to address projects “maintained by small teams or even single individuals” that underpin digital infrastructure well beyond Germany's own borders — it accepts applications globally, not only from German or EU projects, and has funded foundational technologies like curl and GNOME on exactly that basis. A proposal-stage European Union Sovereign Tech Fund would extend the same model continentally. This is, almost implausibly precisely, the funding model Dhar's own framing already matches: a small team building foundational, sovereignty-framed digital infrastructure that the wider ecosystem depends on but does not yet fund. A funding application naming a specific, scoped deliverable (a Stage-delta module, a backend, an audit) rather than general support money is how the fund's own stated model works.

3.2 Nigerian and Pan-African public funding

Casting Dhar §4 already names NITDA as the natural first point of institutional contact through the 3MTT relationship. This Canon does not invent specific Nigerian grant program names here without a confirmed one to cite — the same discipline Casting Dhar §2.2 applies to universities applies to funding bodies. The realistic path is the same door: a 3MTT curriculum relationship (Casting Dhar §2.1) is also the natural entry point for a conversation about institutional or grant support, since it is evidence of adoption a funding body can point to, rather than a cold pitch.

3.3 Corporate sponsorship, once there is something to sponsor

The Rust Foundation's funding model — dues-paying corporate members (its founding members included AWS, Google, Huawei, Microsoft, and Mozilla) who benefit directly from the language's stability — is the template for Dhar once real production usage exists to justify it. This is explicitly a later-stage mechanism: soliciting corporate membership before Stage-epsilon exists asks companies to fund a promise rather than a dependency, which is a much harder sell and not one this Canon recommends attempting early.

4. Sustainability Over Time

The single-maintainer bus-factor risk this document exists to address is not solved by funding alone — money without a second and third contributor able to make Ratified decisions (The Guild of Dhar §6) just delays the same risk. Fueling Dhar's criterion for “funded enough” is therefore not a dollar figure; it is whether funding has been used to grow the number of people who can review, ratify, and maintain the Canon, per The Guild of Dhar's foundation-transition trigger.

5. Relationship to Other Volumes

This document assumes	Ratified in
The license whose trade-offs §2 states	The Hallmark of Dhar
The institutional relationship §3.2 relies on	Casting Dhar §4
The foundation-transition trigger §4 defers to	The Guild of Dhar §6
Funding-dependency risk	The Pact of Developing Dhar (not yet written)

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